



Refresher Course

90 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

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Practice Set 1

Q1. Fire Triangle Fill up the blanks

- A) Fuel
- B) Heat
- C) Oxygen
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Q2. Class A involves flammable liquids. True or False?

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Q3. What is the minimum capacity of emergency fire pumps in meter cube per hour?

- A) 15 meter cube per hour
- B) 20 meter cube per hour
- C) 25 meter cube per hour
- D) 30 meter cube per hour

Correct Answer: C (25 meter cube per hour)

Q4. What is the best fire extinguisher for electrical fires?

- A) CO2
- B) Foam
- C) Water
- D) DCP

Correct Answer: A (CO2)

Q5. What is the color of light used for smaller boats?

- A) Green
- B) Yellow
- C) White
- D) Blue

Correct Answer: C (White)



- A) Hyper mist
- B) CO2
- C) DCP
- D) Foam

Correct Answer: A (Hyper mist)

Q7. How many hours should a diesel-driven fire pump run?

- A) 12 hours
- B) 14 hours
- C) 16 hours
- D) 18 hours

Correct Answer: D (18 hours)

Q8. Dry chemical powder extinguisher works on what principle?

- A) Smothering
- B) Starvation
- C) Inhibition
- D) Cooling

Correct Answer: C (Inhibition)

Q9. Class B bulkheads are classified as B15 and B0. True or False?

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: A (True)

Q10. Maximum temperature of the unexposed side of a B class division:

- A) 300 degrees centigrade
- B) 350 degrees centigrade
- C) 400 degrees centigrade
- D) 250 degrees centigrade

Correct Answer: D (250 degrees centigrade)

Q11. DCP firefighting system is used in which types of vessels?

- A) Oil tankers
- B) Chemical tankers
- C) Bulk carriers
- D) Gas carriers

Correct Answer: D (Gas carriers)



- A) 16 kgs
- B) 25 kgs
- C) 12 kgs
- D) 23 kgs

Correct Answer: D (23 kgs)

Q13. Class A fire extinguisher is best used on:

- A) Solids
- B) Liquids
- C) Gases
- D) Metals

Correct Answer: A (Solids)

Q14. In which language is the fire control plan written on board?

- A) French
- B) English
- C) Spanish
- D) Any local language

Correct Answer: B (English)

Q15. Automatic CO2 release system is for which space?

- A) Accommodation
- B) Main deck
- C) Engine room
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: D (None of the above)

Q16. How often should rescue boards be launched with their assigned crew and manning water?

- A) Every month
- B) Every week
- C) Once in three months
- D) Once in two weeks

Correct Answer: C (Once in three months)

Q17. Your vessel is in collision and you are not sure if your vessel is sinking. How will you handle the situation?

- A) Search for missing persons, monitor the situation, prepare for abandonment if required.
- B) Leave the vessel and stay close by.
- C) Wait and see the situation.
- D) Ensure the lifeboat has enough fuel to reach land.

Correct Answer: A (Search for missing persons, monitor the situation, prepare for abandonment if required.)



- A) 8 nautical miles
- B) 10 nautical miles
- C) 15 nautical miles
- D) 25 nautical miles

Correct Answer: D (25 nautical miles)

Q19. What should be done in case of a fire on board?

- A) Let the wind follow the fire to reduce oxygen.
- B) Let the stem be up against the wind.
- C) Continue on course and speed.
- D) Reduce speed, keep the fire zone leeward.

Correct Answer: D (Reduce speed, keep the fire zone leeward.)

Q20. What is the full form of PASS in portable fire extinguishers?

- A) Pull, Aim, Shut, Sit
- B) Power, Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep
- C) Pass, Aim, Sure, Speed
- D) Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep

Correct Answer: D (Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep)

Q21. How should the painter of a life raft, which is fitted with an HRU, be secured to the ship?

- A) Secured via a weak link to a secure point.
- B) Secured to a part of the hydrostatic release unit that is designed to break free.
- C) It should not be secured in any way.
- D) Directly to a secure point on the ship.

Correct Answer: A (Secured via a weak link to a secure point.)

Q22. Before lifting a lifeboat from water, it must be ensured that:

- A) The bottom plug is shipped.
- B) Fall wires are clear and looped securely.
- C) The engine is going astern.
- D) The anchor is streamed.

Correct Answer: B (Fall wires are clear and looped securely.)

Q23. What is the duration of an emergency escape breathing device (EBD)?

- A) 5 minutes
- B) 8 minutes
- C) 12 minutes
- D) 10 minutes

Correct Answer: D (10 minutes)



- A) 20 minutes
- B) 25 minutes
- C) 30 minutes
- D) 45 minutes

Correct Answer: C (30 minutes)

Q25. The extinguisher that can be used for class F or class K fires is:

- A) CO2
- B) Dry chemical powder
- C) Foam
- D) Wet chemical

Correct Answer: D (Wet chemical)

Q26. Oxygen removal stops fire by:

- A) Cooling effect
- B) Inhibition
- C) Starvation
- D) Smothering

Correct Answer: D (Smothering)

Q27. What is the fourth component of a fire tetrahedron?

- A) Molecular chain reaction
- B) Inhibition
- C) Fire reaction
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: A (Molecular chain reaction)

Q28. What is the color coding of a portable water extinguisher?

- A) Cream
- B) Yellow
- C) Blue
- D) Signal red

Correct Answer: D (Signal red)

Q29. Which type of extinguishers are difficult to recharge on board?

- A) CO2
- B) DCP
- C) Foam
- D) Water

Correct Answer: A (CO2)



- A) 10 meters
- B) 50 meters
- C) 20 meters
- D) 30 meters

Correct Answer: D (30 meters)

Practice Set 2

Q1. Which dangerous condition should be kept in mind after using a 15-pound CO2 fire extinguisher on a small oil fire on the engine room floor plates?

- A) Possible suffocation from the CO2 gas.
- B) Forgetting to secure the engine room ventilation system.
- C) CO2 gas being drawn into nearby engine or air compressor intakes.
- D) Rekindling of the fire.

Correct Answer: D (Rekindling of the fire.)

Q2. Which of the listed classes of fire is considered as one involving electrical equipment?

- A) Class "A"
- B) Class "B"
- C) Class "C"
- D) Class "D"

Correct Answer: C (Class "C")

Q3. Which of the following would be considered a Class "B" fire?

- A) Electrical fire in a motor
- B) Waste rag fire in the engine room
- C) Oil fire in the engine room bilges
- D) Fire in the main switchboard

Correct Answer: C (Oil fire in the engine room bilges)

Q4. If ignited, which material would be a class B fire?

- A) Magnesium
- B) Paper
- C) Wood
- D) Diesel Oil

Correct Answer: D (Diesel Oil)



- A) Dry chemical
- B) Foam
- C) Water
- D) Carbon dioxide

Correct Answer: C (Water)

Q6. Which extinguishing agent is most effective on a mattress fire?

- A) CO2
- B) Foam
- C) Dry Chemical
- D) Water

Correct Answer: D (Water)

Q7. The extinguishing agent most effective for combating wood fires is:

- A) Water
- B) Carbon dioxide
- C) Foam
- D) Dry chemical

Correct Answer: A (Water)

Q8. You are fighting a fire in a watertight compartment using hoses and river water. Stability may be reduced because of:

- A) Progressive down flooding
- B) Reduction of water in the storage tanks
- C) Increase in free surface which reduces the metacentric height
- D) Reduction of KG to the minimum allowable

Correct Answer: C (Increase in free surface which reduces the metacentric height)

Q9. When used to fight fire, carbon dioxide:

- A) Is effective if used promptly on an oil fire
- B) Has a greater cooling effect than water
- C) Is lighter than air
- D) Is harmless to cargo and crew

Correct Answer: A (Is effective if used promptly on an oil fire)

Q10. Carbon dioxide as a firefighting agent has which advantage over other agents?

- A) It causes minimal damage.
- B) It is safer for personnel.
- C) It is cheaper.
- D) It is most effective on a per unit basis.

Correct Answer: A (It causes minimal damage.)



- A) Cool the bulkhead around the fire
- B) Remove combustibles from direct exposure
- C) Close all openings to the area
- D) Shut off all electrical power

Correct Answer: C (Close all openings to the area)

Q12. What is NOT a characteristic of carbon dioxide fire-extinguishing agents?

- A) Effective even if ventilation is not shut down
- B) Will not deteriorate in storage
- C) Non-corrosive
- D) Effective on electrical equipment

Correct Answer: A (Effective even if ventilation is not shut down)

Q13. Foam extinguishes a fire by:

- A) Destroying the burning materials
- B) Chemical reaction with the burning material
- C) Absorbing the burning material
- D) Smothering the burning material

Correct Answer: D (Smothering the burning material)

Q14. Immediately after a class "B" fire has been extinguished by the use of foam, crewmen should:

- A) Carefully apply a low velocity fog over the foam blanket
- B) Wade through the foam blanket to evenly distribute the foam
- C) Be careful not to disturb the foam blanket
- D) Sweep the foam blanket overboard and secure firefighting equipment

Correct Answer: C (Be careful not to disturb the foam blanket)

Q15. The most likely location for a liquid cargo fire to occur on a tanker would be:

- A) In the midships house
- B) At the main deck manifold
- C) At the vent header
- D) In the pump room

Correct Answer: D (In the pump room)

Q16. You should be most concerned about a possible explosion or fire in fuel tanks:

- A) During fueling when the fuel first strikes the tank bottom
- B) During fueling when the fuel strikes fuel already in the tank
- C) When underway as the fuel is moved by wave action
- D) Shortly after fueling when fuel vapors gather

Correct Answer: A (During fueling when the fuel first strikes the tank bottom)

Q17. You have carbon tetrachloride as part of the cargo. If a fire breaks out in the general area, what is the major danger from the carbon tetrachloride?



- A) It will explode if exposed to a flame
- B) Phosgene gas may be formed if it comes in contact with hot metal
- C) It will burn rapidly once ignited
- D) You cannot use water to fight the fire because it will react with the carbon tetrachloride

Correct Answer: B (Phosgene gas may be formed if it comes in contact with hot metal)

Q18. Radiation can cause a fire to spread by:

- A) Transmitting the heat of a fire through the ship's metal
- B) Burning liquids flowing into another space
- C) Heated gases flowing through ventilation systems
- D) The transfer of heat across an unobstructed space

Correct Answer: D (The transfer of heat across an unobstructed space)

Q19. To prevent the spread of fire by conduction, you should:

- A) Cool the bulkheads around the fire
- B) Remove combustibles from direct exposure
- C) Close all openings to the area
- D) Shut off all electric power

Correct Answer: A (Cool the bulkheads around the fire)

Q20. You notice smoke coming from an open laundry room doorway. After activating the fire alarm, which of the following would you do FIRST?

- A) Attempt to determine what is burning.
- B) Acquire the nearest self-contained breathing apparatus.
- C) Break out the nearest fire hose.
- D) Wait for the fire team to arrive and assist as directed.

Correct Answer: A (Attempt to determine what is burning.)

Q21. You are on watch at night in port and discover a fire in #1 hatch. Which action should you take FIRST?

- A) Advise the Chief Mate and Master
- B) Release carbon dioxide into the hatch
- C) Sound the general alarm
- D) Lead a fire hose to the hatch

Correct Answer: C (Sound the general alarm)

Q22. The spreading of fire as a result of heat being carried through a vessel's ventilation system is an example of heat transfer by:

- A) Conduction
- B) Convection
- C) Radiation

Correct Answer: B (Convection)



- A) Gas detector
- B) Fire control plan
- C) Fire and emergency signals
- D) Dry chemical monitor

Correct Answer: C (Fire and emergency signals)

Q24. The high velocity fog tip used with the all-purpose firefighting nozzle should always be:

- A) Stowed separately in a clip or rack at each fire station
- B) Attached to the all-purpose nozzle by a chain
- C) Coated with heavy grease to prevent corrosion
- D) Painted red to be identified as emergency equipment

Correct Answer: B (Attached to the all-purpose nozzle by a chain)

Q25. The most common and widely used cooling agent used for fighting fires on merchant vessels is:

- A) Carbon dioxide
- B) Flue gas
- C) Water
- D) Steam smothering

Correct Answer: C (Water)

Q26. The outlet at a fire hydrant may be positioned anywhere from horizontal to pointing:

- A) 45 degrees upward
- B) Vertically upward
- C) Vertically downward

Correct Answer: C (Vertically downward)

Q27. The primary function(s) of an automatic sprinkler system is(are) to:

- A) Extinguish the fire which triggers it
- B) Limit the spread of fire and control the amount of heat produced
- C) Protect people in the areas which have sprinkler heads
- D) Alert the crew to the fire

Correct Answer: B (Limit the spread of fire and control the amount of heat produced)

Q28. If a portable carbon dioxide fire extinguisher has been partially discharged, it should be immediately:

- A) Tagged and restowed properly in its rack
- B) Weighed and the charge loss recorded before being returned to its rack
- C) Given to the chief engineer for recharging
- D) Tagged 'empty' and stowed separately from charged extinguishers

Correct Answer: D (Tagged 'empty' and stowed separately from charged extinguishers)



- A) Foam conducts electricity.
- B) To be most effective, foam should be directed at the base of the fire.
- C) Foam is most effective on burning liquids which are flowing.
- D) Foam can ONLY be used to extinguish class A fires.

Correct Answer: C (Foam is most effective on burning liquids which are flowing.)

Q30. Which of the following hazards is associated with fuel oil fires?

- A) Emission of noxious gases
- B) Reduced fire-fighting effectiveness due to low oxygen content
- C) Emission of highly flammable vapors
- D) Flashover of confined vapor clouds

Correct Answer: D (Flashover of confined vapor clouds)

Practice Set 3

Q1. A carbon dioxide fire extinguisher is required to be recharged if the weight loss exceeds what percentage of the weight of the charge?

- A) One percent
- B) Five percent
- C) Seven percent
- D) Ten percent

Correct Answer: D (Ten percent)

Q2. Fire hydrant valves on a crude oil tanker shall be isolated from the crude oil washing system by

- A) Spade blanks
- B) Face blanks
- C) Non-return valves
- D) Automatic closing valves

Correct Answer: A (Spade blanks)

Q3. How do you operate a portable CO2 fire extinguisher?

- A) Point the horn down
- B) Turn the cylinder upside-down
- C) Break the rupture disc
- D) Pull pin, squeeze grip

Correct Answer: D (Pull pin, squeeze grip)



- A) Carried by hand to a fire
- B) Carried or rolled to a fire
- C) Recharged in the field
- D) Used on class HB" fires

Correct Answer: A (Carried by hand to a fire)

Q5. Recharging a previously used cartridge-operated dry chemical fire extinguisher is accomplished by

- A) Authorized fire equipment servicing personnel only
- B) Replacing the propellant cartridge and refilling it with powder
- C) Puncturing the cartridge seal after installation
- D) Recharging the cartridge and refilling it with powder

Correct Answer: B (Replacing the propellant cartridge and refilling it with powder)

Q6. Multiple fire pumps may be used for other purposes provided that one pump is

- A) On line to the fire main
- B) Kept available for use on the fire main at all times
- C) Capable of being connected to the fire main
- D) Rated at or above 125 psi

Correct Answer: B (Kept available for use on the fire main at all times)

Q7. Fire hoses should always be stowed at the fire main in a manner which will allow

- A) All sections to be quickly connected
- B) The nozzle end to be run out to the fire
- C) All sections to be quickly drained
- D) The nozzle and fittings to be easily and quickly inspected

Correct Answer: B (The nozzle end to be run out to the fire)

Q8. What is the most vulnerable part of the fire main system?

- A) The fire pumps
- B) Exposed hard piping
- C) The hydrant valves
- D) The fire hose

Correct Answer: D (The fire hose)

Q9. In what location MUST a duplicate fire control plan be located?

- A) Gangway
- B) Engine Room
- C) Crew Mess
- D) Chief Mate's Office

Correct Answer: A (Gangway)



- A) Posted every 150 feet along the most continuous deck on the vessel
- B) Permanently posted for the guidance of ship's officers
- C) Given to each crew member in booklet form
- D) Translated into three languages: English, French and Spanish

Correct Answer: B (Permanently posted for the guidance of ship's officers)

Q11. The muster list shows each rig hand's muster station, his duties during abandonment, basic instructions, and

- A) All emergency signals
- B) Instructions for lowering the survival craft
- C) The time each weekly drill will be held
- D) Work schedule

Correct Answer: A (All emergency signals)

Q12. Which of the following statements is true concerning fire hose stations used in the engine room of a tanker or cargo vessel?

- A) It must be marked in red letters two inches high
- B) National Standard fire hose coupling threads shall be used
- C) In heavy weather, the hose may be removed temporarily from the hydrant

Correct Answer: B (National Standard fire hose coupling threads shall be used)

Q13. A fireman's outfit carried onboard cargo vessels, must have a

- A) Canister-type gas mask
- B) Fresh-air breathing apparatus
- C) Self-contained breathing apparatus
- D) Combustible gas indicator

Correct Answer: C (Self-contained breathing apparatus)

Q14. The international shore connection

- A) Allows hook up of firefighting water from shore facilities
- B) Satisfies pollution prevention requirements
- C) Allows emergency use of the fire main for de-ballasting
- D) Permits discharge of waste oil to shore facilities

Correct Answer: A (Allows hook up of firefighting water from shore facilities)

Q15. Automatic fire dampers in ventilation systems are operated by use of

- A) Heat or smoke detectors
- B) CO2 system pressure switches
- C) Remotely operated valves
- D) Fusible links

Correct Answer: D (Fusible links)



- A) Take part
- B) Watch
- C) Go to their quarters
- D) Stay out of the way and do what they want

Correct Answer: A (Take part)

Q17. The locker or space containing the self-contained breathing apparatus must be

- A) Located in close proximity to the bridge
- B) Equipped with battery powered emergency lighting
- C) Marked "SELF-CONTAINED BREATHING APPARATUS"

Correct Answer: C (Marked "SELF-CONTAINED BREATHING APPARATUS")

Q18. Which type of extinguisher is hard to recharge onboard?

- A) CO2
- B) DCP
- C) FOAM
- D) WATER TYPE

Correct Answer: A (CO2)

Q19. What is the duration of EEBD?

- A) 05 mins
- B) 8 mins
- C) 12 mins
- D) 10 mins

Correct Answer: A (05 mins)

Q20. What action should be taken immediately after a fire has been extinguished?

- A) They are liable to spontaneous combustion
- B) They are not a hazard
- C) They are not a hazard unless ignited
- D) They generate their own oxygen when ignited and difficult to extinguish

Correct Answer: D (They generate their own oxygen when ignited and difficult to extinguish)

Q21. There are two disadvantages to CO2 when used as a total flooding firefighting agent. One of them is extinguishing concentration will not support human life and

- A) The lack of cooling effect on heated materials
- B) It breaks down under extreme heat to form poisonous gases
- C) It cannot be used in a dead ship situation without electrical power available to CO2 pump
- D) There is no effect on class A fire even in an enclosed space

Correct Answer: A (The lack of cooling effect on heated materials)



- A) Smothering the burning material
- B) Chemically absorbing oxygen
- C) Releasing large amount of CO₂
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: A (Smothering the burning material)

Q23. If restricted visibility is encountered in an accommodation fire, you would

- A) Carry a torch
- B) Stand up straight to keep your head above the smoke
- C) Use a fan to blow the smoke and flames
- D) Rig lifelines to assist a retreat

Correct Answer: D (Rig lifelines to assist a retreat)

Q24. Firefighters should come back from the area

- A) After 10 mins of firefighting
- B) Upon instruction from another firefighter
- C) Upon hearing the warning sound from SCBA
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Upon hearing the warning sound from SCBA)

Q25. In portable fire extinguishers, PASS stands for

- A) Pass, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep
- B) Pass, Aim, Shut, Sit
- C) Pass, At, Sure, Speed
- D) Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep

Correct Answer: D (Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep)

Q26. The color coding of a portable extinguisher is

- A) Signal Red
- B) Blue
- C) Black

Correct Answer: A (Signal Red)

Q27. Automatic CO₂ release system is for which space?

- A) Accommodation
- B) Main Deck
- C) Engine Room
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Engine Room)



- A) French
- B) English
- C) Spanish
- D) Any local language

Correct Answer: B (English)

Q29. Class-A fire extinguisher is best used on?

- A) Solids
- B) Liquids
- C) Gas
- D) Metals

Correct Answer: A (Solids)

Q30. What is the maximum weight of a portable fire extinguisher?

- A) 16 Kg
- B) 25 Kg
- C) 12 Kg
- D) 23 Kg

Correct Answer: A (16 Kg)